

Rob Higgins

Staff AI / Platform Engineer · GenAI & Fullstack

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SUMMARY

Staff-level engineer with 10+ years shipping production systems, and recent leadership of LLM/ML platforms at Panorama AI. Builds GenAI product features end to end, including custom tool-calling agents, prompt-driven workflows, and cloud-native Python/React services. Tech lead at Snap for enterprise Web SDKs; used Grafana in production to debug and operate distributed services.

EXPERIENCE

Panorama AI · Dec 2023 – Feb 2026 · Santa Monica, CA

Head of Engineering · Oct 2024 – Feb 2026

- Led data and platform teams behind LLM and ML products: Python services, PostgreSQL, event ingestion, and model inputs; set architecture standards across the org.
- Shipped production GenAI features with custom tool-calling agents for LLM-powered BI and product workflows; iterated quickly from prototype to user-facing releases.
- Drove platform architecture so LLM products could answer business intelligence questions reliably at scale.

Lead Software Engineer · Dec 2023 – Oct 2024

- Built core infrastructure for predictive recommendations and LLM-based business intelligence, including APIs and an embeddable React recommendations widget.

Snap Inc. · Jul 2021 – Sep 2023 · Santa Monica, CA

Software Engineer · AR Enterprise Web SDK Tech Lead

- Tech lead after Snap acquired Vertebrae; owned ARES Web SDK APIs, merchant integrations, event tracking, and experience templating.
- Built a cross-cloud pub/sub layer connecting Snap and Vertebrae backends (GCP/AWS); used Grafana to understand and troubleshoot production system behavior.
- Shipped Camera Kit web and Three.js product experiences with strong ownership of quality, iteration, and cross-team delivery.

Vertebrae Inc. · Feb 2016 – Jul 2021 · Santa Monica, CA + Remote

Senior Fullstack Software Engineer

- Early engineer; built the AR/VR e-commerce platform through Snap acquisition. Owned cloud infrastructure with Terraform, Docker, and microservices at millions-of-users scale.
- Built event tracking/ingestion into PostgreSQL, GitHub Actions CI/CD across repos, and merchant-facing React/Node tools and SDKs.

SKILLS

Python · AI / LLM · GenAI Apps · Tool-Calling Agents · Prompt Engineering · System Design · Observability (Grafana) · React / Node.js · TypeScript / JavaScript · PostgreSQL · AWS / GCP · Terraform · Docker / Kubernetes · Microservices · Event-Driven Architecture · Data Pipelines / ETL · CI/CD · Technical Leadership

EDUCATION

Full Sail University · AAS, Recording Arts Technology